**Northstar SaaS — Business Analysis Brief**

**Prepared for:** Head of Operations and Finance Director
**Project type:** Simulated business case for an analytics portfolio

**Background**

Northstar is a fictional B2B SaaS business providing workflow automation tools to business customers through four subscription plans.

Management wants a clearer picture of business performance and the operational factors that may affect revenue, customer retention, and service delivery.

**Management Request**

The analyst has been asked to investigate six areas of the business:

- Customer growth and acquisition
- Revenue and overdue invoice collection
- Subscription churn and customer retention
- Product usage and engagement
- Sales pipeline performance
- Customer support operations

**Questions Management Needs Answered**

The analysis should identify important patterns, quantify potential business risks, and highlight where additional investigation may be necessary.

In particular, management wants to understand the scale of overdue invoice balances, whether churn patterns vary across customer groups, whether product usage differs between active and churned customers, and whether operational data reveals other areas requiring attention.

**Expected Deliverables**

1. A SQL analysis script documenting the investigation.
2. A Power BI dashboard summarising relevant KPIs and business patterns.
3. A concise set of findings and recommendations that management can use to prioritise further investigation and potential action.

**Analytical Principles**

The analyst should validate data before interpreting results, distinguish observed patterns from proven causes, investigate anomalies, and clearly communicate limitations.

Recommendations should be supported by the available evidence rather than assumptions about why a business outcome occurred.

**Intended Outcome**

Provide management with a clearer, evidence-based view of Northstar's business performance and a practical starting point for deciding which issues warrant further investigation.

*This is a simulated management brief created for a portfolio project. Northstar is fictional and is not a real client.*